

India is a great growth market for The Coca-Cola Company. In volume terms, it is actually the fifth-largest country in the whole Coca-Cola ecosystem, and it is a market that has been growing in the last few years in sync with the country. It is really a story that goes in line with the investments that the government has been making in infrastructure, not only in the physical space, but in digital as well. We have also been enjoying the same ride over the past few years. So, it is an important market that we continue to grow as we look into the future.

►►► ***What are the prospects for Coca-Cola in India in terms of market share growth?***

It is one of the fastest-growing markets, but it is important to put that in context. India also falls into what we call a developing market for us globally. So, it is a market where the industry still has a long way to go when compared to other developed markets. We usually look at that as being one-third of the developed markets as the developing market opportunity. So, we see the market as an opportunity to continue to expand. Coca-Cola is enjoying capturing a part of that growth as we move. It is a

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dual-speed growth strategy in India for us.

►►► ***In terms of the product portfolio, what particular segment excites you the most within the Indian consumption market?***

We have grown pretty much in every category that we have been developing in India. So, sparkling drinks continue to grow. As a matter of fact, last year we saw Sprite become the second \$1-billion brand in India after Thums Up. That shows the potential of the market to grow other \$1-billion brands in terms of revenue. When we look at other categories, we have Limca, which is a typical brand from India that continues to grow in there. We have an opportunity to continue to grow in the future. Maaza is one of my favourites as well and continues to have a good ride. In a nutshell, every (product) category is on a growth path, at different speeds but with [a]

definite future growth.

►►► ***Thums Up has great emotional connect in India, and the decision to bring it back has paid off well for the company. What are your expectations from that brand?***

What I can tell you about Thums Up is that the acquisition was strategic at the moment we made it, and today it complements the portfolio in a very nice way. The way we look at positioning our brands in India and other markets is always by looking at how we connect with the consumer passion points. We are seeing Charged by Thums Up, the energy drink, starting to travel outside India—we have launched in Southeast Asia. So, it is going to continue to grow in India, and perhaps also outside.

►►► ***Is there more to come from Coke Studio, because even those who don't consume your***

products, love the music?

You are touching upon something that everyone went crazy for! We are going to go for the third phase of Coke Studio in India. The first two were a big success. We had other markets in the world that also benefitted from that, but this connects with what I was saying before.

Our marketing always looks at what are the passion points for the consumer and how we can connect [with] them in a different way. There is something unique about the way Indian consumers love to connect with the music, which is from different parts of India. The fusion of that music and how we connected was pretty exciting. I was there in one of those [recordings] and couldn't stand still and had to dance as well. There is a next wave and more to come, and I think our marketing team in India has connected with the consumers very well. We are definitely going to have another great run when it [the next season] comes.

►►► ***Will 2024 be the year for Coca-Cola?***

It is part of the journey. We are in a quiet period as you know, but we have an all-weather strategy—for good times, for difficult times, for challenging times—that connects with our consumers in the best way. We have brands that stay for the long run. So, we are ready for that. **BT**

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